the ‘Vote on Account’. It is passed (or granted) after the general discussion on budget is over. It is generally granted for two months for an amount equivalent to one-sixth of the total estimation.

In an election year (when the Lok Sabha is to be dissolved or a new Lok Sabha is constituted), the Vote on Account may be taken for a longer period (for about 3 to 5 months).

From 2017 onwards, the Budget session is advanced to 31st January and the Union Budget is presented on 1st February, almost a month ahead of the usual date in the past. This change is intended to enable the Parliament to avoid a Vote on Account and pass a single Appropriation Bill for the year, before the close of the financial year.

After the advancement of budget cycle from the last day of February to the first day of February, the Vote on Account is presented in the election year when Interim Budget is presented.

In the year in which General Elections to the Lok Sabha are held, the Interim Budget is presented to the Parliament. After the General Elections are over and assumption of office by the new government, the Regular Budget is presented to the Parliament on a date as decided by the new government.

6. Passing of Finance Bill The ‘Finance Bill’ means the bill ordinarily introduced in each year to give effect to the financial proposals of the Government of India for the next financial year, and includes a bill to give effect to supplementary financial proposals for any period. It is subjected to all the conditions applicable to a Money Bill. Unlike the Appropriation Bill, the amendments (seeking to reject or reduce a tax) can be moved in the case of finance bill.

During this stage, a member can discuss matters relating to general administration, local grievances within the sphere of the responsibility of the Government of India or monetary or financial policy of the government.

According to the Provisional Collection of Taxes Act of 1931, the Finance Bill must be enacted (i.e., passed by the Parliament and assented to by the President) within 75 days.

The Finance Act legalises the income side of the budget and completes the process of the enactment of the budget.

 **Other Grants**

In addition to the budget that contains the ordinary estimates of income and expenditure for one financial year, various other grants are made by the Parliament under extraordinary or special circumstances:

Supplementary Grant It is granted when the amount authorised by the Parliament through the appropriation act for a particular service for the current financial year is found to be insufficient for that year.

Additional Grant It is granted when a need has arisen during the current financial year for additional expenditure upon some new service not contemplated in the budget for that year.

Excess Grant It is granted when money has been spent on any service during a financial year in excess of the amount granted for that service in the budget for that year. It is voted by the Lok Sabha after the